Detailed Logic of the Booking Lifecycle (Final Version)

This document details the complete journey of a booking, integrating validation rules, cancellation policies, and the necessary timelines for professional and transparent management.

Status 1: `Inquiry Pending`

- **Trigger:** A logged-in user submits the booking form.
- **System Actions (Frontend & Backend):**
  1. **Client-Side Validation (Frontend):**
     - When selecting the travel date, the calendar is configured to **disable all dates earlier than today + 5 days**. The user is therefore unable to select an invalid date.
  2. **Server-Side Validation (Backend):**
     - As a security measure, the system double-checks that the `travel_date` is at least **5 days** in the future. If a user were to bypass the frontend validation, the backend would still reject the request.
  3. A new entry is created in the `Bookings` table with the status `Inquiry Pending`.
  4. All user selections (Tour, PackageTier, AddOns, vehicles, currency) are saved.
- **User View (in "My Bookings"):**
  - The status of their booking is: **"Inquiry Sent. Our team will review and respond in under 30 minutes."**
- **Promotional Display (on the homepage/tours page):**
  - A marketing message can be displayed: **"Get your personalized quote in under 2 hours!"**
- **Administrator's View:**
  - A new inquiry appears on their dashboard. This is where the **tracking and validation of the tour** begins.
- **Email Notifications:**
  - **Email to User:** Confirms receipt of the inquiry and informs them that the team is reviewing it with a response time of under 30 minutes.
  - **Email to Administrator:** Alerts of a new inquiry to be processed.

Status 2: `Quote Sent`

- **Trigger:** The administrator, from their dashboard, validates availability and sends the final quote.
- **System Actions (Backend):**
  1. The booking status changes to `Quote Sent`.
  2. The final price is saved.
  3. **Business Rule (Quote Expiration):** An expiration date for the quote is generated, set to **48 hours** in the future.
- **User View (in "My Bookings"):**
  - The status changes to: **"Quote Received. This offer is valid for 48 hours. Ready for Payment."**
  - A **"View Quote & Pay Now"** button appears.
  - A **"Cancel Inquiry"** button remains visible.
- **Email Notifications:**

    - **Email to User:** Informs them that their quote is ready, specifying its 48-hour validity period.

Status 3: `Payment Confirmed`

- **Trigger:** The user successfully completes the payment.
- **System Actions (Backend):**
    1. The status changes to `Payment Confirmed`.
    2. The payment transaction ID is saved.
    3. A timestamp (`payment_timestamp`) is recorded with the exact date and time of the payment.
- **User View (in "My Bookings"):**
    - The status changes to: **"Booking Confirmed! Your trip is scheduled."**
    - **New Cancellation Logic:** A **"Cancel Booking"** button is visible. This button will only be **active if less than 24 hours have passed since the `payment_timestamp`**. After this period, the button is disabled.
- **Email Notifications:**
    - Confirmation emails are sent to the user and the administrator.

Status 4: `Cancelled`

- **Case A: Cancellation before payment (from `Quote Sent` status)**
    - **Trigger:** The user clicks "Cancel Inquiry".
    - **Action:** The status changes to `Cancelled`.
- **Case B: Cancellation after payment (from `Payment Confirmed` status)**
    - **Trigger:** The user clicks "Cancel Booking".
    - **Business Rule (Cancellation Window):** The system checks if the current date and time are within **24 hours following the `payment_timestamp`**.
        - **If yes:** The cancellation is accepted. The status changes to `Cancelled`, and a refund process is initiated.
        - **If no:** The action is denied, and a message explains that the 24-hour cancellation window has passed.
    - **User View (if cancellation is successful):** The booking appears as "Cancelled - Refund in process."

Final Status: `Trip Completed`

- **Trigger:** The administrator manually marks the trip as completed.
- **System Action:** The status changes to `Trip Completed`. An email can be sent to the user inviting them to leave a review.

Terms & Conditions Page

A dedicated "Terms & Conditions" page will be created and accessible from the footer. It will detail all the business rules we have defined:

1. **Booking Policy:** Minimum 5-day advance booking, inquiry does not guarantee reservation, etc.
2. **Quote Policy:** Response times, 48-hour validity.

3. **Cancellation & Refund Policy:** Free cancellation before payment, 24-hour window for cancellation after payment.
4. **Payment Policy:** Use of the secure payment gateway.

NB: If anything to add or to modify, just let me know!